I could cancel the tariffs a year ahead of schedule, because they had made a turnaround and no longer needed protection to compete with the Japanese.

I'd been hearing stories of how American industry was learning to be more competitive, but at the Harley Davidson plant—as I later did in every corner of the country—I saw firsthand what was happening, and it was a thrilling experience. I'd always believed that the vast majority of American workers, whatever their work, have an inherent pride that makes them want to excel, and that when this fund of pride and energy is liberated, we are unbeatable at whatever we do.

We are not a lazy people; we are an innovative, pragmatic, industrious people, and have demonstrated as much time and again during more than two centuries of problem-solving. At the Harley Davidson plant, I was told how managers and assembly-line workers had joined in a team to figure out how they could beat back their competition from Japan. Meeting around a table, production workers and their bosses talked over their jobs. They discussed how they ordered and handled inventory, and how parts were utilized on the assembly line. The workers pitched in and came up with ideas for doing their jobs more efficiently and improving the quality of the products they made. As the workers became more involved in decision-making, the result was a drastic change in operations that made the whole plant more efficient. Also, where the company had once made a single model, it had now developed a family of motorcycles of different sizes to compete with the motorcycles from Japan.

The Harley Davidson workers told me they could now compete with anyone in the world. What a difference, I thought, between a factory worker like that and one in a Communist factory, who is given no choice of a job, just ordered to go there, and given no incentive to make a